

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 7 3
♥ 10
♦ 10 8 6 4 3
♣ J 10 9 5

♠ J 6 5

♥ 7 6 4

♦ A K J

♣ A K 6 3

N
W E
S

♠ K 4 2

♥ Q J 9 8 5 3

♦ Q 7 2

♣ Q

♠ A 10 9 8

♥ A K 2

♦ 9 5

♣ 8 7 4 2

West	North	East	South
	1NT	2♥	2NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♥
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North

There are several possibilities for extra winners. The ♦ Q might drop - or the finesse might work, providing one winner. The ♣s might split 3-2, giving you one extra winner. The ♠ honors might be split (or East might hold both) so the double finesse would give you two winners. Since your minor suit hopes require that BOTH of them work, your best bet is the double ♠ finesse.

You do not need to hold up on the ♥ because you will be finessing twice into West, and he cannot possibly have more than two ♥s, probably only one. Come to your hand with a ♣, play the ♠ J and let it ride. West wins the ♠ Q and plays another ♣. Win this one and finesse the ♠ again. When this finesse works you can return to your hand with a ♦ and repeat the finesse.

The double finesse has a 75% chance of success since it only requires that East hold either the ♠ K, ♠ Q, or both.

Even if West held both honors you would **STILL** have established one ♠ winner and would have the possibility of a ♦ finesse.

Partner's 2NT is lebensohl, requesting that you bid 3♣. You obey and partner now bids 3♥.

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The cue-bid is Stayman, asking if you have 4 ♠s. However, since it was a DELAYED cue-bid it also shows stopper(s) in the opponent's overcalled suit. Since you do not have 4 ♠s you go ahead and bid 3NT.

North plays 3NT.

East naturally attacks in his suit, leading the ♥ Q.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 7

Board 3

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J 8 6 4

♥ 9 2

♦ Q 8 7

♣ 9 4

♠ 5 2

♥ A 7 3

♦ K 10 4 3

♣ K J 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 7 3

♥ J 10 8 5

♦ J 6

♣ Q 10 8 7 3

♠ A 10 9

♥ K Q 6 4

♦ A 9 5 2

♣ A 5

West

2 ♠

Pass

All Pass

3NT by South

North

Pass

3NT

East

Pass

South

2NT

Partner's 1NT overcall shows 15-18 points and guarantees a ♠ stop. With 11 points and no 4-card ♥ suit you say 3NT.

The contract would be 3NT played by North.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠ K. Do you hold up or not?

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 8

You need just one more winner. It could come from a finesse of the ♣ J. It could come from a 3-3 ♥ split. It could come by establishing a fourth card in ♦ s.

Most important for now is the ♠ lead? Do you hold up?

Yes you should hold up. In fact you might as well hold up twice since you aren't contemplating a throw-in of West. Holding up twice will protect you in the unlikely event that West made his 2 ♠ bid with a 5-card suit.

Both the ♥ possibility and the ♣ possibility will either work or not, so you can save them for later. Your highest percentage chance is the fourth ♦, but here you must be careful. You must try to establish the ♦ s without allowing West to get the lead. It is actually pretty easy. Just play a small ♦ from your hand and when West plays low insert the ♦ 10. East wins the ♦ J but cannot harm you with his return.

When the remaining ♦ s fall you have established your ninth trick.

Suppose West inkles out what you are trying to do and inserts his ♦ Q when you play the low ♦ toward dummy?

If he does that he hands you all four ♦ tricks!